

edge sharing. ThinkFree also allows importing images from Flickr. If you use Facebook, you can add “ThinkFree Docs” to your apps list, and upload, publish and share your documents with your friends. Without much effort, you can find documents or even PowerPoint (or rather ThinkFree Show) presentations on topics like Using Ajax Libraries and Tools, Database objects, and other subject areas from varying realms of technology. Documents here are even rated in the genre of being most popular, highest rated and featured docs. On further searching here, you will find subject areas as diverse as stress management, animation, stocks and investment, baby care and even hobbies. It is easy to get lost in the ocean of resources on this site. The site’s recommendations say that you should have JRE 5.0 or later on your system for comfort while using the service; you can find the latest JRE on our CD every month. All ThinkFree services come with two options—Quick edit and Power edit. While you can Quick edit without any specific requirements, it is only for the Power edit that you need the Runtime environment.

So what should we expect from the ThinkFree stable? They have possibly given all that you can think of. The amount of free available resources is indeed outstanding. As far as performance of the whole suite goes, ThinkFree undoubtedly stands out. Among all the suites mentioned so far, nothing beats ThinkFree on compatibility with MS Office. As per the site, they have entered a new agreement with the largest Australian ISP—BigPond (from the house of Telstra)—to power a set of Web-based productivity tools. The tools will be available to the public as BigPond Office, now available at www.bigpondoffice.com.au. The BigPond testers have done rigorous testing on the ThinkFree Office suite before giving their go ahead. Need we say more about ThinkFree?

Considering all the praise that it gets, let take a closer look at it. Among all the online office suites, it would really be difficult to rate them, more so against an offline conventional office suite such as MS Office. The criteria are diverse; needs and tastes vary.

The latest buzz is that Google is in talks with ThinkFree for a possible acquisition. This is surely a much-sought-after story, and with so much of media hype around ThinkFree, it’s going to stay on our radar for quite a while.